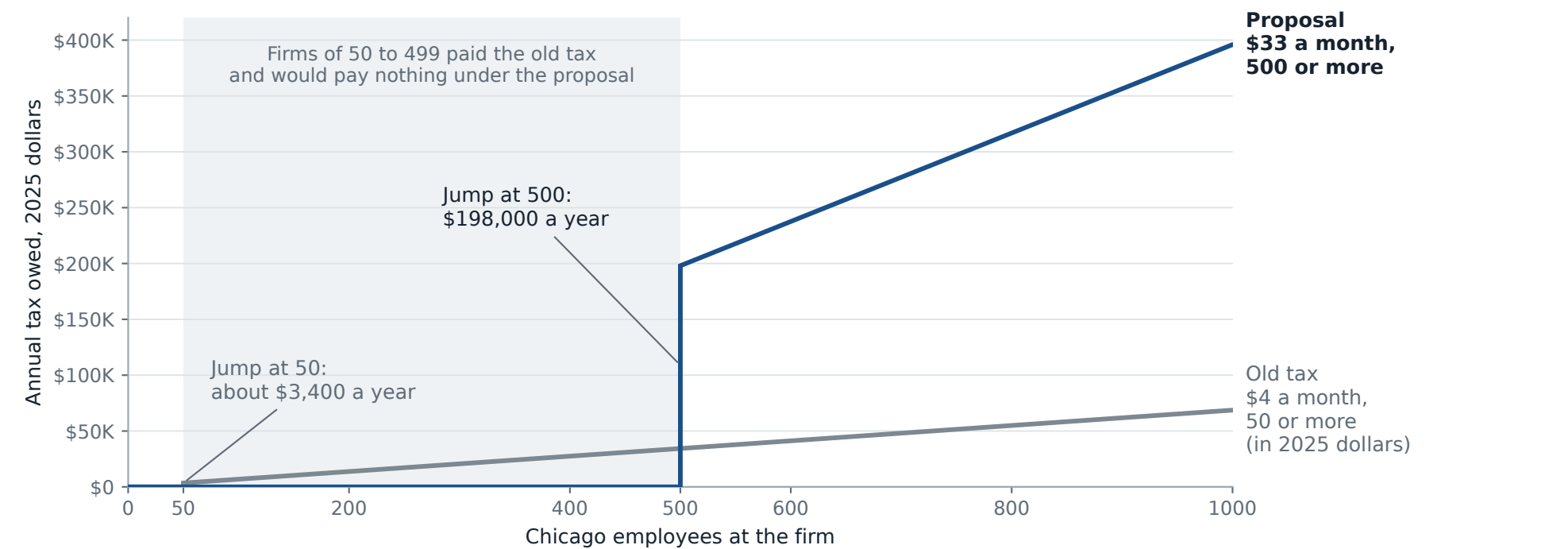


The proposal puts a far steeper cliff in front of far larger firms

Annual tax owed by firm size. Per employee the proposal is 6 times the old rate; the jump at its threshold is 58 times the old one



Both taxes are notches: below the threshold a firm owes nothing, and at the threshold it owes on every employee, so the tax jumps by the annual rate times the threshold. Old tax: \$4 per employee per month at 50 or more employees, the full rate until 2011 (\$48 per employee and \$2,400 at the threshold in nominal terms; halved in 2012, repealed at the end of 2013), inflated to 2025 with the CPI-U annual average (factor 1.431). Proposal: \$33 per employee per month at 500 or more. In nominal terms the jump is 82.5 times larger. Rates and thresholds only; the lines do not depend on the business data.

Sources: Employer's Expense Tax Ruling #2 (2005), quoting Municipal Code 3-20-030(A); WBEZ, 12 December 2025; Bureau of Labor Statistics CPI-U.